EMAIL OUTREACH GUIDE

Consumer Data Email Starter Stack

Your step-by-step guide to emailing consumer leads with maximum deliverability and response.

TOTAL MONTHLY COST	DAILY SEND VOLUME	SETUP TIME
~$40/month	20-50 emails	One afternoon

Why This Guide Exists

You've got a list of consumer leads — people who previously expressed interest in insurance, mortgage, financial, or similar products. Whether those leads are fresh or aged, the opportunity is real.

But the opportunity only converts if your emails actually land in inboxes and get opened.

This guide gives you a dead-simple, low-cost system to email consumer data with the highest possible delivery rate and response rate. No marketing degree required. No expensive software. Just a proven process any insurance agent or mortgage broker can set up in a single afternoon.

Know the Rules (It's Simpler Than You Think)

CAN-SPAM says cold commercial email is legal in the US on an opt-out basis. You do NOT need prior consent to email. But you MUST follow these rules:

- Use your real name and business name in the "From" field
- Write honest, non-deceptive subject lines
- Include your physical mailing address (P.O. Box is fine)
- Include a working unsubscribe link in every email
- Honor unsubscribe requests within 10 business days

Violations can cost $50,000+ per email. Follow these rules and you're fully legal.

Your Email Starter Stack

You only need four things. Total cost: about $40/month plus a few dollars per batch for email verification.

Tool	What It Does	Cost
Outreach domain (via GoDaddy)	Separate domain that protects your main business website	~$12/year
Google Workspace	Professional email on your outreach domain	$7/month

ZeroBounce or NeverBounce	Verifies email addresses before you send	~$8 per 1,000 emails
GMass	Sends personalized emails from your Gmail inbox	$25/month

Step-by-Step Setup

1 Buy a Separate Outreach Domain

This is the single smartest thing you can do before sending a single email. **Never send cold outreach from your main business domain.** If your emails trigger spam filters or get reported, it's your outreach domain that takes the hit — not the domain where your website, business email, and reputation live.

How to pick your outreach domain name:

Use a variation of your business name that's clearly associated with you but separate. Add a prefix like "go", "get", "try", "meet", or "hello" to your business name. Here are some examples:

Your Business	Main Domain	Outreach Domain
Smith Insurance	smithinsurance.com	gosmithinsurance.com
Apex Mortgage	apexmortgage.com	getapexmortgage.com
Premier Financial	premierfinancial.com	meetpremierfinancial.com
Davis Agency	davisagency.com	trydavisagency.com

Buying Your Domain

How to buy your domain on GoDaddy (5 minutes):

1. Go to **godaddy.com** and search for your chosen domain name.
2. Pick a **.com** domain if available. If not, **.co** or **.net** work too.
3. Add to cart and check out. Decline all add-ons and upsells.
4. Total cost should be around **$12-15/year**.

Don't build a website on this domain. You just need it for email. A simple one-page landing page with your business info is fine but not required.

2 Set Up Google Workspace on Your Outreach Domain

Google Workspace gives you a professional email address on your outreach domain (like mike@gosmithinsurance.com). It costs $7/month and takes about 15 minutes.

Here's exactly what to do:

1. Go to **workspace.google.com** and click "Get Started."
2. Enter your business name and select your outreach domain (the one you just bought on GoDaddy).
3. Create your email address. Use your real first name: **mike@gosmithinsurance.com** or **sarah@getapexmortgage.com**.
4. Google will ask you to verify domain ownership. Follow the instructions — you'll add a small code to your GoDaddy DNS settings. Google walks you through it step by step.
5. Once verified, Google automatically configures **SPF** and **DKIM** — these are email authentication records that prove you're a legitimate sender.

> **✓ Pro Tip**
>
> Add a **DMARC** record too. In your GoDaddy DNS settings, add a TXT record with the name **_dmarc** and the value **v=DMARC1; p=none; rua=mailto:your@email.com**. This is a one-time 5-minute task that further protects your deliverability.

3 Verify Your Lead Emails Before Sending

This is the most important step for deliverability. Consumer lead data — especially aged leads — contains email addresses where people have changed jobs, switched providers, or abandoned old accounts. Sending to dead addresses destroys your sender reputation and gets you flagged as spam.

Here's exactly what to do:

1. Go to **zerobounce.net** or **neverbounce.com** and create a free account.
2. Upload your CSV file of leads.
3. The tool checks every email address and flags which ones are valid, invalid, or risky.
4. Download the cleaned list — only keep the "valid" addresses.

5. For aged data, expect to remove 20-40% of addresses. That's normal and exactly why this step matters.

> **✓ Pro Tip**
>
> ZeroBounce gives you 100 free verifications to start. After that, it's about $8 per 1,000 emails. This small investment saves your domain reputation.

4 Install GMass and Connect Your Google Sheet

GMass is a Chrome extension that turns your Gmail into a mail merge and outreach tool. It's the simplest way to send personalized emails from a real inbox.

1. Go to **gmass.co** and install the Chrome extension.
2. Open Google Sheets and paste your verified lead list (from Step 3) into a new spreadsheet. Make sure you have columns for First Name, Last Name, and Email at minimum.
3. Open Gmail (logged into your outreach domain account). You'll see a new GMass button next to the Send button.
4. Click the GMass icon, connect your Google Sheet, and GMass will pull in your lead list automatically.

> **✓ Pro Tip**
>
> GMass has a free tier that lets you send 50 emails/day. Perfect for testing before you commit to the $25/month plan.

5 Write Your Email (Keep It Human)

Gmail's spam filters use AI to detect mass marketing emails. The secret to landing in the inbox is to write emails that look and feel like a real person wrote them — because you did.

Rules for your email:

- **Plain text only.** No images, no HTML formatting, no colored text, no logos.
- **Short.** 3-5 sentences max. Respect their time.
- **One link maximum.** Your calendar link or website. That's it.
- **Personalize.** Use {FirstName} merge tags. Reference the type of product they were interested in.
- **Clear subject line.** "Quick question about your life insurance options" beats "EXCLUSIVE OFFER INSIDE!!!"

Sample Email Template

Subject: Quick question, {FirstName}

Hi {FirstName},

I noticed you were exploring life insurance options a while back. I'm a licensed agent in [your state] and I help people find coverage that fits their budget.

Would it be worth a quick 5-minute call to see if I can help? No pressure at all.

Best,
[Your Name]
[Your Phone Number]
[Your Company]
[Your Address]

6 Set Your Sending Speed (Small Batches Win)

This is where most people mess up. They try to blast hundreds of emails at once and immediately get flagged as spam. The right approach is the opposite: **slow and steady**.

Recommended sending schedule:

- **Week 1:** Send 10-15 emails per day
- **Week 2:** Increase to 20-25 per day
- **Week 3+:** Settle at 30-50 per day

In GMass, go to Settings and set your daily sending limit. GMass will automatically space your emails throughout the day so they don't all go out at once.

> ✓ **Pro Tip**
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> 50 emails/day = 250/week = 1,000/month. That's a very solid outreach volume for a solo agent. And because you're sending from a real Gmail account at human speed, your delivery rate stays above 95%.

Need Leads to Email?

Get high-quality aged consumer leads — insurance, mortgage, solar, and more.

Buy Aged Leads

Use Promo Code: BILLRICE to get 10% off — every order!

7 Set Up Your Unsubscribe Link

This is legally required and GMass makes it automatic.

In GMass settings, enable the "Auto-append unsubscribe link" option. GMass adds a small, clean unsubscribe link at the bottom of every email. When someone clicks it, they're automatically removed

from future sends.

Don't hide it or make it hard to find. A visible unsubscribe link actually **helps** your deliverability — it tells Gmail you're a legitimate sender who respects recipients.

8 Hit Send and Track Your Results

Once everything is set up, click the GMass button to send your campaign. GMass will show you real-time stats:

- **Open rate** — aim for 30%+ (great for cold email)
- **Reply rate** — aim for 3-8% (excellent for consumer leads)
- **Bounce rate** — should be under 2% if you verified in Step 3
- **Unsubscribe rate** — under 1% is healthy

Reply to every response personally and promptly. These are warm conversations — treat them like gold.

> ✓ **Pro Tip**
>
> Send a follow-up email 3-4 days later to people who opened but didn't reply. GMass can automate this with its built-in sequence feature. A simple "Just bumping this to the top of your inbox" can double your response rate.

Deliverability Checklist

Before you send your first campaign, run through this checklist:

- ☐ Separate outreach domain purchased (not your main business domain)
- ☐ Google Workspace set up on outreach domain
- ☐ SPF, DKIM, and DMARC configured (SPF/DKIM are auto with Google Workspace)
- ☐ Email list verified through ZeroBounce or NeverBounce
- ☐ Plain text email written (no images, no HTML formatting)
- ☐ Subject line is honest and specific

- [ ] Physical mailing address included in email (P.O. Box works)
- [ ] Unsubscribe link enabled in GMass
- [ ] Daily send limit set to 20-50
- [ ] Follow-up sequence created (optional but recommended)

Do's and Don'ts

✓ DO	✕ DON'T
Use a separate outreach domain	Send cold email from your main domain
Verify emails before every send	Send to unverified, raw lists
Write short, conversational emails	Write long marketing newsletters
Send 20-50 emails per day	Blast 500+ emails at once
Use plain text formatting	Use images, logos, or HTML templates
Include a clear unsubscribe link	Hide or omit the unsubscribe option
Follow up 1-2 times politely	Send 10 follow-ups to non-responders
Respond to replies within hours	Let warm leads sit for days

Ready to Level Up?

Once you're comfortable with the Starter Stack and want more automation, tracking, and pipeline management, consider upgrading to a CRM with built-in email outreach. Here are the best options for insurance agents and mortgage brokers:

CRM	Best For	Email Features	Price
Instantly.ai	Cold email at scale	Unlimited accounts, warmup, AI writing, auto follow-ups	From $30/mo
GoHighLevel	All-in-one marketing for insurance/mortgage	Email + SMS + CRM + landing pages + automation	From $97/mo
Mailshake	Simple cold email with phone dialer	Email sequences, A/B testing, built-in phone dialer	From $29/mo

Woodpecker	Small teams doing B2C cold email	Auto follow-ups, bounce shield, deliverability monitor	From $29/mo
Close CRM	Sales-focused CRM with calling built in	Email sequences, power dialer, SMS, pipeline mgmt	From $29/mo
HubSpot CRM	Growing teams who want a free CRM base	Email tracking, templates, sequences (paid tier)	Free CRM; Email from $20/mo

★ Recommendation

Our recommendation for most agents and brokers:

Start with the **Starter Stack** (outreach domain + Google Workspace + ZeroBounce + GMass) for your first 30 days. This lets you learn the process, refine your messaging, and see real results with minimal investment.

Once you're consistently getting replies and booking appointments, upgrade to **Instantly.ai** (if you want to scale email volume) or **GoHighLevel** (if you want an all-in-one system with SMS, landing pages, and appointment booking).

Get Started with Aged Leads Today

Insurance, mortgage, solar, and more — verified and ready to work.

Buy Aged Leads

Use Promo Code: BILLRICE to get 10% off — every order!

Questions? Visit **HowToWorkLeads.com** for more guides, tips, and strategies.

Disclaimer: This guide is for informational purposes only and does not constitute legal advice. Consult with a qualified attorney regarding email marketing compliance in your specific jurisdiction. Tool pricing and features are subject to change.

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